

theadFate's Edge Adventure  
wenvironmentcoreinnovation

**Core Innovation Box:**

# The Memory Merchant's Labyrinth

## Large A Fate's Edge Adventure for Tiers IIII

### LargeCore Concept Framework

#### largeAdventure Identity Statement

**What makes this adventure sing?** A heist adventure where memories are the ultimate currency, and players must steal from a merchant who trades in stolen experiences while navigating a maze that shifts based on collective memory.

**What is the central tension?** The players must balance their need for powerful memories against the risk of losing their own identities in the process.

**What will players remember?** The moment they had to choose between a memory that could save a friend or one that could damn an innocent person.

#### largeThematic Pillars

tem **Horror by Consent** Players willingly risk their memories for power tem **Social by Manipulation** Memory trading creates complex webs of obligation tem **Exploration by Discovery** The labyrinth reveals itself through remembered truths

### LargeStructural Template

#### largeAct I: Entry Engagement

##### Hook (Opening Scene)

The PCs wake in a memory auction house with no recollection of how they arrived. Their belongings are gone, replaced with “debt markers” memories they supposedly owe to the Memory Merchant. A holoprojection of a smiling woman’s face explains: “Welcome to your payment plan. You have seven days to retrieve seven memories, or you’ll wake up as someone else entirely.”

##### Establishment Beats

tem **The Memory Market:** Players navigate the bizarre auction house where memories are traded like commodities. They witness a man literally forget how to love after selling that memory, and a woman who bought “courage under fire” but now panics at the sight of her own reflection. tem **First Debt:** The Merchant’s assistant explains one of their debts they must steal “The Last Sunrise Memory” from the labyrinth. The memory belongs to an elderly man who’s the last person to see the sun before the Great Dimming. tem **The Labyrinth Revealed:** Players enter the memory maze, which immediately shifts based on what they remember about their missing memories. The walls are made of crystallized experiences, and touching them reveals fragments of other people’s lives.

## largeAct II: Complications Choices (Continued)

### Rising Tension

tem **Competing Collectors:** Another group is also hunting for memories “Memory Purists” who believe memories shouldn’t be traded. They’re willing to kill to “free” memories, creating a threeway conflict. tem **The Price of Remembering:** Each memory the players acquire changes them slightly. They gain abilities tied to those memories but also inherit the emotional baggage. A memory of “perfect revenge” makes them more aggressive; “first love” makes them more empathetic but also more vulnerable. tem **The Merchant’s True Debt:** Discovery that their “debt” was manufactured they were targeted because they possess a memory the Merchant desperately needs: witnessing a crime that never officially happened.

### Midpoint Crisis

The labyrinth begins to collapse as the players’ memories start bleeding into the maze itself. Walls show their childhood fears, corridors echo with voices of people they’ve forgotten. They realize the labyrinth is feeding on their confusion to grow stronger. The elderly man who owns “The Last Sunrise” offers to help, but his price is one of their own precious memories.

## largeAct III: Climax Resolution

### Approach to Climax

Players must choose: steal the Merchant’s ultimate memory (which could destroy the memory trade forever) or find a way to expose her crimes without becoming like her. The labyrinth grows more unstable as their own memories become unreliable.

### Climactic Encounter

**The Memory Throne Room:** A battle of wits and wills where players must navigate not just physical space but mental space. The Merchant can weaponize memories against them, forcing them to experience traumatic events or tempting them with perfect alternate lives.

### Resolution Aftermath

tem **If they destroy the memory trade:** Memories return to their original owners, but some people lose abilities they’d come to depend on. The players gain a permanent ability to sense when memories are false. tem **If they expose the Merchant:** She’s arrested, but the memory market goes underground, becoming more dangerous. Players gain connections in the legitimate memory recovery business. tem **If they join the Merchant:** They become memory merchants themselves, gaining incredible power but slowly losing their original identities.

## LargeMechanical Integration Framework

**Signature System: Memory Resonance** Players can “tune” into memories left in objects/locations

tem **Purpose:** Make memory exploration tactile and risky tem **Integration:** Uses existing skill system but adds memoryspecific consequences tem **Player Agency:** Choose which memories to absorb and which risks to take tem **Sample Uses:**tem Touching a murder weapon to see the crime (but risk absorbing the killer’s rage) tem Holding a wedding ring to experience the marriage (but inherit relationship baggage) tem Reading a diary page to gain knowledge (but the writer’s neuroses)

## largeResource Management Layer

### AdventureSpecific Resources:

tem **Memory Debt Tracker** [7]: Players must acquire 7 memories or lose their identities  
tem **Identity Stability** (010): How much of themselves players retain drops when absorbing powerful memories  
tem **Memory Echoes**: Temporary abilities gained from absorbed memories (1 session duration)

### Asset Building Opportunities:

tem **Recovered Memories**: Permanent abilities tied to significant memories  
tem **Memory Anchors**: Items that help maintain identity stability  
tem **Debt Forgiveness**: Reduces required memories through moral choices  
tem **Memory Network**: Contacts who can provide/sell memories

## largeCustom Mechanics Integration

### New Resolution Method: Memory Infiltration

tem **Approach**: Wits + Insight or Presence + Sway  
tem **Position**: Based on how personal the memory is to the target  
tem **Success**: Gain memory + temporary ability  
tem **Partial**: Gain memory but suffer emotional consequence  
tem **Miss**: Memory backfires, target's trauma becomes yours

### Timer Architecture:

tem **Labyrinth Stability** [8]: Maze becomes more dangerous as players destabilize it  
tem **Identity Dissolution** [6]: Players lose themselves the longer they stay  
tem **Merchant's Plan** [10]: Her scheme to acquire the forbidden memory progresses  
tem **Memory Market Corruption** [6]: Underground trade becomes more dangerous

## LargeGM Support Systems

### largeSession Preparation Checklist

tem [ ] Core memories needed for each debt clearly defined  
tem [ ] Memory Merchant's true goal and backup plans  
tem [ ] Labyrinth layout that shifts based on player memories  
tem [ ] Emotional consequences for each major memory  
tem [ ] Competing faction motivations and tactics  
tem [ ] Identity stability effects at different thresholds

## largePlayer Agency Reminders

### At Choice Points:

tem "What piece of yourself are you willing to risk for this memory?"  
tem "Who suffers if you take this memory from them?"  
tem "How will this memory change who you are tomorrow?"  
tem "What would your past self think of this trade?"

### When Tension Lags:

tem Introduce memory echoes that conflict with current situation  
tem Have the labyrinth shift to reflect player fears  
tem Force identity stability checks during crucial moments  
tem Bring in Memory Purists with extreme solutions

## largeComplication Generator

tem **Mild (1 SB)**: Memory echo conflicts with current task; brief identity confusion tem **Moderate (2 SB)**: Labyrinth shifts to traumatic memory; temporary skill loss tem **Serious (3 SB)**: Someone else claims the memory first; identity stability drops tem **Major (4+ SB)**: Memory contains a hidden curse; player must choose which memory to lose permanently

## LargeThematic Consistency Tools

### largeTone Maintenance

**Opening Description:** “The air tastes of forgotten dreams and the metallic tang of crystallized thoughts. Every surface whispers with the ghostimpressions of experiences that no longer belong to their owners.”

#### NPC Voices:

tem **Memory Merchant**: Speaks in perfect, calculated sentences that feel like they're reading from a script tem **Elderly Man**: Voice cracks with age and the weight of too many sunrises remembered tem **Memory Purist Leader**: Passionate but fanatical, speaking in absolutes about the sanctity of experience

**Environmental Storytelling:** Walls show fragmented scenes from memories a child's first steps, a lover's betrayal, a parent's death all playing simultaneously like a broken film reel.

### largeTheme Reinforcement

#### Each Scene Should:

tem Challenge players' understanding of what makes a memory “theirs” tem Present choices between power and authenticity tem Reveal how memories shape identity through concrete examples tem Connect to larger themes about commodification of experience

### largeMoral Complexity Integration

#### Gray Choices:

tem Steal a memory that's destroying its owner vs. respecting their right to keep it tem Trade a friend's embarrassing memory for a crucial ability tem Help the Memory Purists destroy the trade vs. letting people make their own bad choices tem Take a memory that could prevent a crime but was gained through torture

## LargeResolution Path Framework

### largeMultiple Valid Approaches

tem **Direct Confrontation**: Face the Merchant in her memory throne room tem **Market Manipulation**: Work within the memory trade to bankrupt or expose her tem **Purist Alliance**: Join forces with Memory Purists to destroy the labyrinth entirely tem **Identity Sacrifice**: Become the new Memory Merchant to control the trade ethically

## largeOutcome Matrix

tem **Success:** Gain powerful memories, but at the cost of some personal identity tem **Compromise:** Partial victory that leaves the memory trade in a new but uncertain state tem **Failure:** Become memory debt slaves or lose crucial parts of who they are tem **Transformation:** Players fundamentally change their approach to knowledge and experience

## largeConsequence Types

tem **Immediate:** Memory echoes that last the session tem **Ongoing:** Permanent changes to skills/abilities based on absorbed memories tem **Character:** Identity stability becomes a persistent resource to manage tem **World:** Memory trade either reformed, destroyed, or driven underground

## LargeScalability Framework

### largeTier Adaptation

#### Lower Tiers:

tem Reduce Memory Debt Tracker to [5] tem Simplify labyrinth to fewer shifting elements tem Focus on 23 core memories instead of 7 tem Make consequences less severe (temporary vs. permanent changes)

#### Higher Tiers:

tem Add political factions who use memory trade for espionage tem Include other memory merchants with competing schemes tem Expand to multiple labyrinth locations across different realms tem Add time pressure as memory market collapse threatens reality

## largeSession Modularity

### Can Break Into:

tem **3session arc:** Entry first debts, Labyrinth exploration Merchant's scheme, Final confrontation tem **2session adventure:** Market introduction first 3 debts, Labyrinth climax tem **1session encounter:** Single memory heist with identity consequences

## LargeDocumentation Standards

### largePlayerFacing Materials

tem **Memory Debt Card:** Track owed memories and acquired ones tem **Identity Stability Tracker:** Visual representation of self vs. absorbed memories tem **Labyrinth Map Sheet:** Dynamic map that players can mark as it shifts tem **Memory Echo Cards:** Temporary ability cards with emotional consequences

## largeGM Quick Reference

tem **Memory Merchant's True Motivation:** She witnessed a crime that would destroy a major patron tem **Key Memory Descriptions:** 1015 memories with abilities and conse-

quences tem **Labyrinth Shift Triggers:** When to change the maze based on player actions  
tem **Identity Stability Effects:** What happens at different stability levels

## largeAdventure Scaling Notes

**Fast Play:** Focus on 3 core memories and simplified labyrinth

**Deep Dive:** Include all factions, memory market politics, and longterm consequences

**Character Spotlights:** Each PC's background memories become part of the debt

**Campaign Integration:** Memory trade becomes ongoing source of quests and complications

## LargeQuality Assurance Checklist

### largeEssential Elements

tem [x] Clear adventure identity statement about memory commodification tem [x] Meaningful choices between power and identity tem [x] Integration with core Fate's Edge mechanics through custom Memory Resonance tem [x] Custom mechanics that serve the memory theme tem [x] Multiple valid approaches to the central conflict tem [x] Clear escalation from market exploration to labyrinth climax tem [x] Memorable NPCs with distinct motivations tem [x] Atmospheric location descriptions focused on memory themes tem [x] Meaningful resource management through Identity Stability tem [x] Consequences that ripple forward into future sessions

### largeExcellence Indicators

tem [x] Mechanical innovation (Memory Resonance) serves narrative about experience commodification tem [x] Player agency reinforced through memory choice consequences tem [x] Thematic consistency maintained through identity vs. power tension tem [x] Multiple resolution paths with different philosophical implications tem [x] Consequences feel earned and tie to player choices tem [x] Scalability options clearly marked for different tiers tem [x] GM support materials comprehensive for memory management tem [x] Safety considerations around identity loss and memory manipulation

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*The Memory Merchant's Labyrinth* challenges players to confront what makes them who they are, while providing concrete mechanical systems for exploring the intangible nature of memory and identity. The adventure's strength lies in making abstract concepts tactile through the Memory Resonance system and Identity Stability resource, creating a unique experience that could only exist in Fate's Edge's narrativefirst framework.